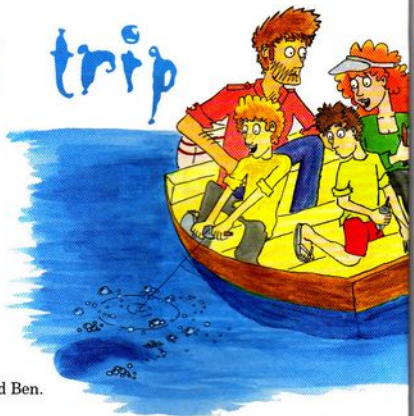


Fishing trip



Ben lived by the sea. He loved fishing and often went out in the boat with his mum and dad.

Once a year the Big Boomer Fishing Contest was held. There was a prize for the person who caught the biggest fish on a hand line. Ben was checking his fishing tackle for the contest when the phone rang. His mum answered it.

'Your cousin Andy is on his way,' she told Ben.
'He wants to come fishing with us.'

Ben's dad rolled his eyes. 'That boy is as clumsy as a puppy,' he said. 'He's sure to fall out of the boat.'

'He'll be OK,' Mum said. 'He'll catch something.'

Dad snorted. 'The only thing he'll catch is a cold.'

The boat ramp was very busy on the day of the contest. A long line of boats waited to get in the water. Andy's gear was a mess. It took him a long time to sort it out. While Ben helped Andy, Mum caught a sea trout and Dad caught a nice whiting. At last, Andy tossed out his line.

'Careful,' Dad warned him. 'That's where the reef is. You'll snag your line on the rocks.'

Andy just smiled. He had already felt a tug on his line. 'I've caught something!' he shouted. 'Something big!'

There was a storm of bubbles in the water and a big black shape came up on Andy's line. It wasn't a fish. It wasn't a lump of seaweed. It wasn't an old boot. It was a scuba diver. Andy had hooked her wetsuit. She was *not* happy!

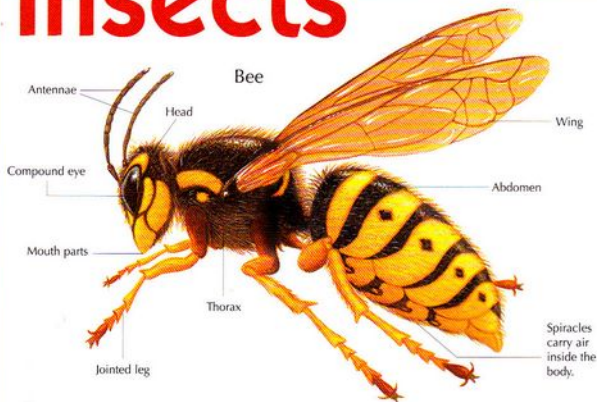
Dad looked at Andy. 'I think we'd better move,' he said.

They pulled up the anchor and started the engine. Andy stood up and waved goodbye to the scuba diver.



1. Why did Ben want to go fishing?
 - (A) to show his parents a good fishing spot
 - (B) to take part in a fishing contest
 - (C) to teach his cousin how to fish
 - (D) to try out his new fishing line
2. Why was Dad disappointed that Andy was coming on the fishing trip?
 - (A) He was worried Andy would catch a cold.
 - (B) The boat was too small to include Andy.
 - (C) Andy was not a good fisherman.
 - (D) Andy could not swim.
3. What was Ben doing when Mum caught a sea trout?
 - (A) helping Andy
 - (B) catching a whiting
 - (C) tossing out his line
 - (D) waiting in the line of boats
4. From the description of the 'storm of bubbles', the reader can tell that
 - (A) the sea was rough.
 - (B) the weather was turning bad.
 - (C) the boat was rocking on the waves.
 - (D) the diver was coming to the surface.
5. Why does the writer repeat the words 'It wasn't' in the third last paragraph?
 - (A) to create a list that is easy to read
 - (B) to build suspense about what is coming
 - (C) to tell the reader what Andy hoped to find
 - (D) to show that there are many things in the sea
6. Why did the writer put the word 'not' in *italics* in the sentence 'She was *not* happy!'?
 - (A) to make it easier to read
 - (B) to show that it was an exclamation
 - (C) to point out a change in the narrative
 - (D) to draw attention to how the diver felt
7. Why did Dad say, 'I think we'd better move'?
 - (A) The fishing contest was over.
 - (B) He wanted to find bigger fish.
 - (C) The boat was too close to the reef.
 - (D) He was embarrassed by Andy's actions.

Insects



Seven-spotted ladybird (beetle)



Common cockroach



Privet hawkmoth



Bluebottle (fly)



Emperor dragonfly



Bush cricket

Insects are the most successful of all animal groups. They make up 85% of the whole animal kingdom. There are as many as 10 000 insects living on every square metre of the earth's surface. It is possible for insects to live in almost any environment and to eat nearly all kinds of food.

There are many different kinds of insects but they all share a common body design. All adult insects have a segmented body which is divided into three parts: head, thorax and abdomen. All insects have three pairs of jointed legs, and most have four wings. The pictures show some easily recognisable insects.



Firebug



Wood ant

8. On which part of an insect's body are the spiracles found?

(A) the head
(B) the thorax
(C) the abdomen
(D) the wings



9. According to the information, what do all insects have in common?

(A) They have three pairs of legs.
(B) They have four wings.
(C) They have striped bodies.
(D) They have antennae on their abdomens.



10. It is possible to tell from the information that

(A) there are 10 000 different types of insect in the world.
(B) the largest part of a wood ant is its head.
(C) the common cockroach has smooth legs.
(D) 85% of all living creatures in the world are insects.

11. What type of insect is a ladybird?

(A) a fly
(B) a beetle
(C) an ant
(D) a moth

12. Which of the illustrations below shows a firebug?



(A)



(B)



(C)



(D)

13. In this illustration the arrow is pointing to

(A) a wing.
(B) the thorax.
(C) the abdomen.
(D) a mouth part.



14. The words 'easily recognisable' mean the insects are

(A) clever.
(B) popular.
(C) common.
(D) harmless.

The mirror

Grandma loved mirrors. She had at least one in every room of the house. They were all different. Some were very old with carved, wooden frames. Others were sleek and modern with plain, straight sides. There was even one that Nikki had made for her, with seashells glued to it in two higgledy-piggledy rows as if the sea had dumped them around the edge of a glassy rock pool.

'I always think a mirror makes a room so light and bright, don't you?' Grandma would say when anyone asked why she had so many.

But the mirror on the dressing table was her favourite. 'This one belonged to my great-aunt, Veronica. I used to stay with her a lot when I was your age. Come,' Grandma whispered, 'I'll let you in on a secret.' She had pulled out the padded stool that fitted neatly under the dressing table in the space between the two sets of drawers. Nikki had bent down with Grandma and looked into the shadowy darkness. 'You can crawl in through here,' Grandma said. 'And come out on the other side of the mirror. It's the best hiding place when your mother is cross with you,' she winked at Nikki, 'or when you want to get away from your bossy cousins.'

Nikki laughed. 'Did you do that when you were little?'

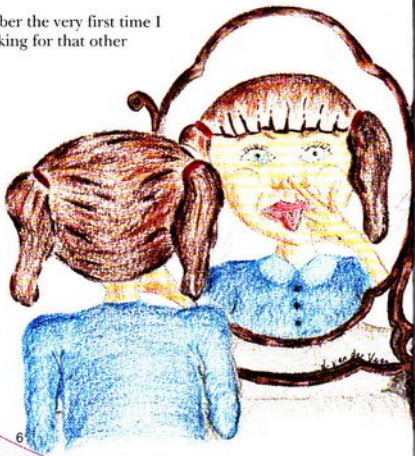
'Of course,' Grandma said. 'I can remember the very first time I went all the way through there. I was looking for that other girl.'

'What other girl?'

'The one in the mirror,' Grandma had pointed at her own reflection. 'I wanted her to talk to me, but she just kept pulling faces.' Grandma made her eyes go slanty and puffed out her cheeks.

'Like this?' Nikki laughed and joined in, sticking out her tongue and flattening her nose. Grandma paused to study her.

'You know, I do believe that other girl looked a lot like you.'



15. What does the word 'sleek' mean?
(A) new (B) silver (C) smooth (D) ordinary
16. Which statement best describes the mirror that Nikki made for Grandma?
(A) It had two untidy rows of seashells around its frame.
(B) It had a picture of the sea with a border of seashells.
(C) It had two rows of seashells glued on a photograph of a rock pool.
(D) It had an image of a rock pool pasted on the glass surrounded by seashells.
17. In the sentence 'You can crawl in through here', the word 'here' refers to
(A) the mirror.
(B) the set of drawers.
(C) the other side of the mirror.
(D) the space under the dressing table.
18. Why did Grandma go all the way to the other side of the mirror the first time?
(A) She wanted to talk to the girl she saw in the mirror.
(B) She wanted to ask the girl in the mirror to stay with her.
(C) She wanted to stop the girl in the mirror from pulling faces.
(D) She wanted to find out why the girl in the mirror looked like Nikki.
19. Nikki said, 'What other girl?' because she was
(A) frightened by the mirror.
(B) curious to find out more.
(D) worried about meeting her.
(C) bored with Grandma's story.
20. At the end of the text the writer has created a mood of
(A) despair. (B) sadness. (C) mystery. (D) horror.
21. Much of the narrative is written using dialogue. This enables the writer to
(A) illustrate that Grandma gives wise advice to Nikki.
(B) avoid describing the actions of Grandma and Nikki.
(C) show the close relationship between Grandma and Nikki.
(D) demonstrate that Grandma and Nikki are extremely talkative.

Spaced Out!

Your body in space

Travelling into space must be one of the most exciting and wonderful experiences anyone could ever have. It also has some interesting effects on the human body.

In space there is hardly any gravity, which means astronauts' bones and muscles don't have to work as hard as on Earth to enable them to stand straight or move around. The weightless feeling is similar to what you experience in a swimming pool, only more so. Because muscles (including the heart) don't have to work so hard in space, they shrink and become very weak.

The oxygen we breathe gives our muscles the energy we need to move and with less muscle tissue to feed, there is a lot more oxygen in the astronauts' blood. The astronauts' bodies slow down the production of red blood cells—the part of blood that transports oxygen around our bodies—otherwise there would be too much oxygen in the body. This makes the blood thicker.

Bones lose a lot of calcium—a chemical that makes bones stronger—and become weak and brittle because they don't have to support as much muscle weight.

When astronauts return to Earth, their bodies are adapted to life in space but are not yet fit for life on Earth. As they get used to the Earth's gravitational pull again, they become fitter and stronger and their blood, muscles and bones eventually return to normal.

Spacesuits

Spacesuits are difficult and uncomfortable to wear, so they are only worn for five to seven hours at a time. They are like mini-spacecraft with everything a human body needs to stay alive, such as oxygen and equipment to create the same temperature and pressure that we experience on Earth.

Spacesuits have to be made of thick, tough material to shield against tiny meteorites (micrometeorites) speeding through space. The side of the suit facing the Sun may be heated to a temperature as high as 120 °C; the other side, exposed to the darkness of deep space, may get as cold as -150 °C.



22. The opening sentence can best be described as
- an opinion.
 - a command.
 - an explanation.
 - a well-known fact.
23. Which words would best replace 'hardly any' in the text?
- still some
 - even less
 - almost no
 - always a little
24. The writer compares the weightlessness of being in space to
- floating in water.
 - standing up straight.
 - wearing a spacesuit.
 - falling through the air.
25. Which word is closest in meaning to 'brittle', as it is used in the text?
- fragile
 - stiff
 - painful
 - flexible
26. The word 'micrometeorites' is written in brackets () because it is
- a definition.
 - a quotation.
 - a translation.
 - a scientific name.
27. According to the text, which option correctly matches a statement with its result?
- | | Statement | Result |
|-----|--|---|
| (A) | The temperature is lower in space. | Astronauts use less energy. |
| (B) | Fewer red blood cells are produced by the body in space. | Blood becomes thicker in space. |
| (C) | Spacesuits have to be worn for a few hours everyday. | Spacesuits have to be made of tough material. |
| (D) | Spacesuits have to carry equipment to control temperature. | Astronauts wear comfortable spacesuits. |
28. Based on this text, which of the following statements about space is correct?
- All meteorites are large and travel fast.
 - People can live without oxygen in space.
 - In space there are extremes of temperature.
 - The force of gravity in space and on Earth are the same.

Out of bounds

I left the house and did what I had so often been told not to do: I climbed over the low, ivy-covered wall of the garden of the Convent of Sainte-Antoine and walked among the trees towards the building. When I reached the low shrubs, I went down on my knees and crept along until I could see the small courtyard of the convent. There was no-one about. I walked past the old cactuses in pots and was about to risk crossing the courtyard, when a sudden shadow in the doorway and the sound of a little bell surprised me. I dived behind a couple of low willow trunks. Soeur Béate came out. She held a small copper bell in her hand which she swung carefully. When she made soft sucking and clicking noises with her mouth, striped cats appeared from different parts of the garden, among them Copernicus. She bent and put a dish down on the ground.

The cats approached soundlessly, tails up in the air. They stalked around the dish and nipped like spoiled women at the sauce in which pieces of meat floated. Soeur Béate didn't stay; she disappeared almost immediately into the coolness of the convent building. I stood up and ran past the doorway like a chicken escaping from its pen. The cats barely looked up. Their bodies undulated gently as they swallowed. I walked past the herb garden and the gravestones at the side of the building.

The hardest part was getting past the four geese in their run. The moment I appeared they started gabbling and wouldn't stop till I got to the small pond in among the greenery. I pulled my T-shirt over my head and took my shoes off. The mud felt warm on my feet. I waded through a narrow strip of tall wild irises and reeds. The roots stopped me sinking too far into the mud, and the water there was lukewarm. Only where the water reached to my waist did it get cooler. Air bubbles rose along my legs, bringing black grit to the surface with them.

'This is more like it,' I thought when I felt my body cooling off and relaxing. 'This is better than a shower. Better than sitting still near that stupid house with that boring garden. This they'd envy me, those guys back home with their barbecues.' I sniffed the scent of decaying plants. If I stayed still, dragonflies skated over the water towards me. Even though there was no wind, the surface of the water rippled occasionally. The air was full of the hum of insects.

29. The narrator realised someone else was present when
- (A) he heard a bell ringing.
 - (B) he saw the cats coming.
 - (C) he saw Soeur Béate standing in the courtyard.
 - (D) he heard Soeur Béate making noises with her mouth.
30. Which quotation from the second paragraph suggests that the cats were uninterested in the narrator's presence?
- (A) 'tails up in the air'
 - (B) 'stalked around the dish'
 - (C) 'nipped like spoiled women'
 - (D) 'barely looked up'
31. The word 'undulated', as it is used in the text, means that the cats' bodies
- (A) vibrated.
 - (B) stiffened.
 - (C) moved up and down.
 - (D) wobbled from side to side.
32. Which word best describes the narrator's attitude when he compares his own situation with that of the people back home?
- (A) disappointed
 - (B) smug
 - (C) jealous
 - (D) spiteful
33. What is the purpose of the detailed description of the narrator's experience in the pond?
- (A) to show that he was enjoying himself
 - (B) to hint that the pond contained hidden dangers
 - (C) to emphasise the beauty of the pond's natural setting
 - (D) to allow him to remember everything when he went home
34. Which quotation from the text is **NOT** a grammatically complete sentence?
- (A) 'There was no-one about.'
 - (B) 'Soeur Béate came out.'
 - (C) 'Only where the water reached to my waist did it get cooler.'
 - (D) 'Better than sitting still near that stupid house with that boring garden.'
35. Which word best describes the narrator?
- (A) dreamy
 - (B) adventurous
 - (C) careless
 - (D) trustworthy

Adventure Castle



Would you like to have the chance of a lifetime, to push yourself to the edge of your physical and mental boundaries? Are you up for a challenge, prepared to work as part of a team or even to become a leader among your peers? If you like problem solving, adventure and fun, then Channel LV would like to invite you to be on *Adventure Castle*, a brand new concept for a children's television game show which will air every day over six weeks in our after-school timeslot.

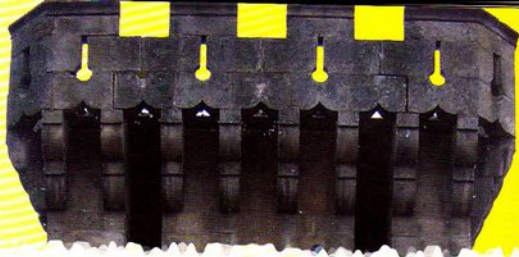
Adventure Castle features two teams of contestants, Battleaxe and Dagger, competing to be the first to escape from a medieval castle. To do this, the teams have to rack their brains to solve a series of twisted logic puzzles and strategy games and take part in the all-out Team Challenge.

The Team Challenge occurs at the end of each week. Teams will be given a set of tools and a time limit to complete a task. The task could be a test of sheer bravery, such as swinging from the castle walls to land on a floating craft in the moat, or it could require a feat of creative engineering, such as designing and building a catapult that can hurl a boulder the furthest distance.

But it's not just about being the fastest or strongest. Our panel of judges will also be rewarding or deducting points for cooperation and teamwork. At the end of the week, each team will vote for a new leader who will have special privileges. But this comes with the extra responsibility of making decisions that can either ruin the team's chances or pave the way to final victory.

Whether you are an outgoing type who is often first to have your views heard or a quiet strategist planning behind the scenes, *Adventure Castle* could be your chance to make new friends, build your leadership skills and have great fun.

If you are aged between 9 and 13 and would like to take part, go to www.channelLVtvstudios/adventurecastle/application to download an application form. Send the form to us along with a letter telling us why you would make a great contestant. *Adventure Castle* is awaiting you!



36. Why does the writer begin the text with questions?
- (A) to capture the attention of the reader
(B) to echo the kinds of questions readers have
(C) to show that Channel LV is sure of the answers
(D) to indicate that the writer will provide answers later
37. The word 'twisted' indicates that the puzzles and games are
- (A) rare. (B) dangerous. (C) competitive. (D) complicated.
38. What is the main aim of the *Adventure Castle* game?
- (A) to help the other teams as much as possible
(B) to get out of the castle as quickly as possible
(C) to complete as many Team Challenges as possible
(D) to solve the puzzles and games as creatively as possible
39. According to the text, *Adventure Castle* provides children with the opportunity to
- (A) use their creativity and intelligence.
(B) learn survival skills for the outdoors.
(C) develop skills which they can use at home.
(D) work with others who are faster and stronger.
40. What strategy have the makers of *Adventure Castle* used to encourage readers to participate in the show?
- (A) They target those who have internet access.
(B) They limit the age range of children who can enter.
(C) They describe the potential contestants in a positive way.
(D) They provide ideas for how to solve some of the puzzles.
41. What type of text is this?
- (A) a review
(B) a recount
(C) an advertisement
(D) a newspaper report

For questions 42 and 43 choose the CORRECT PUNCTUATION to complete the passage.

The Gingerbread Man

A little old woman began to bake and all at once she knew what to make.

'I'll mix him and stir him and put him in a pan and then I shall bake my gingerbread man (42)

But out of the oven there came a cry, 'Let me out! Let me out (43) I don't want to fry.'

She opened the oven. He raced for the door.

'You'll never catch me,' the little man called.

42. (A) full stop (.)
(B) full stop and inverted comma (,.)
(C) question mark and inverted comma (?.)
(D) comma and inverted comma (,.)
43. (A) full stop and inverted comma (,.)
(B) question mark (?)
(C) exclamation mark (!)
(D) comma and inverted comma (,.)



For questions 44 and 45 choose the correct option to complete the sentence.

44. Standing quietly by the side of the athletics field, my friend _____
(A) to look at her race to begin.
(B) waited for her race to begin.
(C) anxious for her race to begin.
(D) watching for her race to begin.
45. Before Andrew's brother started walking with him to school, he _____ catching the bus.
(A) would be
(B) had been
(C) has been
(D) was to be

<i>ICAS B ENG- ANSWER KEY</i>	<i>2010</i>
1	B
2	C
3	A
4	D
5	B
6	D
7	D
8	C
9	A
10	D
11	B
12	D
13	B
14	C
15	C
16	A
17	D
18	A
19	B
20	C
21	C
22	A
23	C
24	A
25	A
26	D
27	B
28	C
29	A
30	D
31	C
32	B
33	A
34	D
35	B

36	A
37	D
38	B
39	A
40	C
41	C
42	B
43	C

44	B
45	B



E

2010 English Answer Keys

ICAS
International Competitions
and Assessments for Schools

Question Number	Paper A	Paper B	Paper C	Paper D	Paper E	Paper F	Papers G & H	Papers I & J
1	B	B	C	B	B	D	C	A
2	D	C	A	B	C	B	A	C
3	C	A	B	C	B	B	B	B
4	C	D	A	B	B	D	C	B
5	A	B	B	D	A	B	C	A
6	D	D	B	B	B	C	A	A
7	A	D	C	A	C	D	A	D
8	B	C	D	C	A	D	D	C
9	C	A	A	D	C	A	B	A
10	B	D	B	B	D	C	D	B
11	D	B	C	D	A	C	B	C
12	A	D	C	A	C	A	D	C
13	B	B	A	B	D	D	A	D
14	D	C	B	C	B	B	A	B
15	D	C	D	D	C	A	B	D
16	B	A	A	A	A	B	A	D
17	C	D	D	D	D	D	C	C
18	A	A	C	A	A	B	D	A
19	D	B	B	C	C	C	A	C
20	A	C	C	B	A	A	D	C
21	B	C	A	A	A	C	C	D
22	A	A	D	D	D	A	A	C
23	C	C	C	B	C	B	C	B
24	D	A	B	D	B	C	C	A
25	B	A	A	A	A	C	D	D
26	B	D	D	C	C	A	D	D
27	D	B	B	C	D	A	B	A
28	A	C	D	B	B	D	B	D
29	D	A	B	A	D	B	D	B
30	B	D	D	C	B	B	C	A

(Please turn over)



E

2010 English Answer Keys

ICAS
International Competitions
and Assessments for Schools

Question Number	Paper A	Paper B	Paper C	Paper D	Paper E	Paper F	Papers G & H	Papers I & J
31	C	C	A	D	D	C	D	A
32	A	B	C	B	D	B	A	C
33	C	A	C	B	A	B	B	C
34	A	D	B	A	C	A	D	A
35	A	B	A	D	C	C	C	A
36	D	A	A	A	A	A	C	D
37	B	D	D	C	D	B	D	B
38	C	B	B	A	D	D	C	C
39	D	A	A	A	D	D	C	D
40	B	C	C	D	D	C	B	A
41	D	C	D	C	A	B	A	C
42	B	B	C	B	C	C	D	B
43	C	C	D	D	C	A	B	D
44	C	B	D	B	B	B	C	A
45	A	B	B	D	A	A	D	B
46			A	C	A	A	A	A
47			D	A	C	C	C	C
48			A	B	A	C	B	B
49			D	C	B	B	D	C
50			A	C	C	A	A	A
51					A	D	A	A
52					D	D	B	B
53					B	D	B	B
54					D	C	D	A
55					C	C	C	C
56							A	D
57							A	C
58							D	D
59							A	B
60							C	B

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